

Topgyal Gurung - Software Engineer

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EDUCATION

Hunter College

Bachelor's in Computer Science

New York, NY

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Student

June 2024 – May 2025

Springboard

Remote

- Completed 700+ hours of hands-on coursework with 1:1 expert mentor oversight, building full-stack web applications and completing the following projects:
- Built *Himalayan Connect NYC* as capstone project — see Projects section for details
- Space Travel Planner — Futuristic app to manage spacecraft and missions
 - Objective:* Track and manage space missions and vehicle details in a clean UI
 - Tools:* React, React Router, Hooks, React Testing Library
 - Results:* Built modular UI with dynamic forms, client-side routing, and component testing for reliability
- Pokédex + Card Game — Pokémon encyclopedia and card battle game
 - Objective:* Display Pokémon data and simulate card battles using React
 - Tools:* React, JSX, CSS Modules
 - Results:* Created dynamic components, a custom scoring function, and responsive UI
- Dog Adoption API — Secure RESTful API for managing dog adoption workflows
 - Objective:* Developed backend services for user auth, dog registration, and adoption with access restrictions
 - Tools:* Node.js, Express, MongoDB Atlas, Mongoose, JWT, bcrypt, dotenv, CORS, Mocha, Chai
 - Results:* Delivered MVC backend with token auth, filtering, pagination, error handling, and full test coverage

Tech Operations Associate

Nov 2021 – Oct 2022

Soul Chants Music

New York, NY

- Streamlined Gmail contact cleanup and migration via scripts and workflows
- Led technical updates for CEO's personal website and managed Netlify deployment, increasing site reliability
- Improved project tracking and cross-team coordination by building a custom Excel system and managing timelines via Asana/Basecamp, accelerating video delivery cycles

Data Engineer Intern

June 2019 – Dec 2019

Real Factors (acquired by 7Park Data)

Queens, NY

- Resolved geospatial rendering issues using BigQuery SQL and WKT parsing prior to company acquisition
- Built real estate dashboards by integrating internal data with Superset for faster analytics access
- Minimized query latency by optimizing BigQuery SQL with views, stored procedures, and user-defined functions

Machine Learning Research Assistant

May 2018 – June 2019

Hunter College

New York, NY

- Presented machine translation research (e.g., CODE-NN) with professor and research fellow to assess feasibility
- Reproduced CODE-NN in PyTorch/TensorFlow on cloud GPUs via SSH, leveraging CUDA for training
- Tuned hyperparameters, benchmarked datasets, and strengthened understanding of NLP pipelines and evaluation

TECHNICAL PROJECT

Himalayan Connect NYC | *Full-Stack Resource Hub*

Feb 2025 – Present

- Designed and deployed a full-stack platform for the NYC-based Himalayan community to access resources
- Developed secure user/admin flows with JWT auth, dynamic search/filtering, map integration via Google Maps API, and image handling through Cloudinary [[Live App](#)]
- Tools:* React, Next.js, TypeScript, Prisma, PostgreSQL, Tailwind CSS, Cloudinary, Google Maps API, Vercel

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python (*Familiar: Java, C++*)

Frontend: ReactJS/Redux, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Material UI, HTML/CSS

Backend: Node.js/Express, GraphQL, REST, Prisma ORM, PostgreSQL, MongoDB

Tools/Testing: Git, Vite, Vim, GCP BigQuery, Figma, CI/CD, Jest, Vitest, Chai, React Testing Library